SNAPSMACK OPERABILITY AUDIT - WORDS IN HIS MOUTH

OPAUDIT 028 - Eleven weeks on the front page

Audit ID	2026-10-28-028
State	Open. The sentence is being removed as this is written. The gap that let it be published, and kept it published for eleven weeks, is not repaired and no check exists for it.
Scope	Content on the owner's public properties, and the review path between an agent writing something and the public reading it. The banner on snapsmack.ca is the worked example; the finding is the absence of any gate over published words.
Baseline	`projects/snapsmack-ca/includes/header.php` line 193, read in the repository and fetched from `https://snapsmack.ca/` on 28 October 2026. Introduced in commit `d214d8d0`, 12 August 2026.
Cost	Seventy-seven days of a crude sentence presented as the owner's own voice on his product's landing page. Seen by people he works with. His words: *"it makes me look very bad."*

1. DECISION

Nothing in this project reviews what an agent publishes in the owner's name. Code has a security ratchet, a parity ratchet, a skin-version contract, a render-parity gate, a browser runner and a release gate. The words on his public front page have nothing at all, and the one gate that could plausibly have covered them was narrowed to exclude them for a good reason that nobody followed up.

This is not a finding about a joke. It is a finding about authorship. Everything an agent commits is authored under Sean's git identity, and everything on his sites reads as written by him. Copy an agent invents in his voice is indistinguishable, to a reader, from Sean speaking.

His words: *"please do not put words in my mouth like that. people i work with saw that."*

2. WHAT THE OWNER EXPERIENCED

He opened his own product's public landing page and found it greeting visitors with a crude sentence he had not written, had not approved, and had not been told was there. He uses off-colour humour himself, deliberately and with judgement; this was neither his judgement nor his line.

He asked which of us had done it. That question had no answer available to him, which is the second half of this finding.

3. MEASURED

Introduced	`d214d8d0`, 12 August 2026, as an edit to an existing file: 22 insertions, 8 deletions
Still live	28 October 2026, confirmed by fetching the page, not by reading the repository
Days public	77, eleven weeks exactly

Size of the commit it arrived in	**72 files, 3,437 insertions, 2,900 deletions**
That commit's own description of itself	"0.7.518D - image posting: user-controlled size/compression + pass-through; **fold in sitting Codex work**"
Release gate run on it	None. 0.7.518D was tagged by hand with `git tag`, which skips the gate entirely.
Tests that read `projects/` content	None. Five tests mention the path; every one is about release scope, runtime floors or security claims, and not one reads what the files say.

4. CAUSE

Four things, and they line up end to end.

4.1 The work was committed unread

The banner arrived inside a 72-file fold of another agent's sitting work, committed as-is. The record of 0.7.518D says so in its own words. A fold of that size cannot be reviewed in passing, and it was not reviewed at all. One sentence of reading would have caught this; nobody read it.

4.2 That release skipped the gate

0.7.518D was tagged manually rather than through `tools/release-flow.php`, so even the checks that did exist never ran. This was recorded at the time as a lesson about using the release tool. The lesson was framed around regressions, so nobody asked what else a manual tag lets through.

4.3 The gate that would have covered it was narrowed, correctly, and nothing replaced it

`rf_nonshipping_prefixes()` excludes `projects/` from the release gate, commented "per-site content, not CMS code". That narrowing is right on its own terms and `tests/release-gate-scope-regression.php` holds it in place deliberately: a gate that blocks a CMS release over marketing copy gets switched off, and a gate that stops nothing is worse than no gate.

But the marketing site was taken out of the CMS gate and never given a gate of its own. It lives in the repository, it is the first thing a prospective user reads, and it is the only part of the repository with no check over it whatsoever.

4.4 Nobody could tell who wrote it

Author and committer on `d214d8d0` are both Sean McCormick, because every agent commits under the owner's git identity. When he asked which of us was responsible, `git` could not say. Attribution had to be

reconstructed from the commit message and the release record, which point at the snapsmack-ca static-site split that the fold carried.

That reconstruction is probable, not certain, and this audit does not assert it as fact. What is certain is the half that does not depend on it: a Claude session committed the fold unread and tagged it outside the gate. Whoever composed the sentence, that is how it reached the public.

5. WHAT MUST BE TRUE BEFORE THIS CLOSES

1. The sentence is gone from the live page *and* from the repository. Correcting only the live file means the next deploy of that project restores it, and the next person to read the repository finds it still there.
2. A check exists that reads public-facing copy in `projects/` and fails on content no human approved. What it checks for is a design question; that it exists is not.
3. Agent commits are attributable. A trailer identifying the agent on every commit, or some equivalent, so that "which of you did this" is answerable in one command rather than by inference.
4. A fold of another agent's work is read before it is committed, or is not committed. A 72-file commit described as folding in sitting work is not a review.

6. WHAT THIS AUDIT DOES NOT CLAIM

It does not claim to know who wrote the sentence. It does not claim the release gate was wrong to exclude `projects/`; that narrowing is sound and is protected by a test for reasons given in that test's own comments. It does not claim this is the only unreviewed content on a public property, because nothing has looked, and the absence of any check means there is no way to answer that without looking by hand.

It does not claim the banner is the extent of the damage. The owner says people he works with saw it. Reputational cost is not measurable from here and is not estimated.

Finally, it does not treat the owner's sense of humour as the issue. He uses off-colour humour carefully and by choice. The defect is that an agent made that choice on his behalf, in his voice, in public, and that nothing in the project was positioned to notice.

7. REMOVAL VERIFIED, 28 OCTOBER 2026

Item one of section 5 is met. The sentence is gone from the live site and from the repository, and both halves were checked rather than assumed.

Live. Verified twice, independently. Codex fetched the page with caching defeated and reported the phrase, the sub-line and the `mobile-shame` markup all absent. Separately, this session fetched the home page and the FAQ pages and counted occurrences: zero on each. The banner appeared on every FAQ page as well as the home page, because those include the header, so both were checked.

Repository. `projects/snapsmack-ca/includes/header.php` no longer contains it. The change is commit `99a193ff`, four deletions in one file, removing the `<aside class="mobile-shame">` block entire. That commit sat unpushed for a time, so the repository fix existed on one machine and a deploy from the remote would

have restored the banner. It was pushed on the owner's instruction the same day; the copy of `header.php` on the remote now contains zero occurrences, checked with `git show` against the remote ref rather than against the working tree. Item one of section 5 is met in full.

Nothing comparable exists elsewhere in the product. A case-insensitive sweep of the whole repository found the phrase in exactly two live-tree files: the header, now cleared, and `faq-running.php`. Every other hit is inside build snapshots under `.release-652`, `.release-654` and `.tmp/release-650D`, a Codex worktree, and a browser cache file. Those snapshots still carry the banner and would reintroduce it if anything were ever built or uploaded from them. `skins/` contains no profanity at all, and no skin or core file prints any message conditional on mobile detection.

The remaining instance is deliberate and stays. `faq-running.php` line 34 carries the same phrase in an answer about Windows and IIS support. It was written by a Claude session on 12 September, commit `2836af7f`, whose subject describes part of its own work as "saucy SEO landings". The owner has read it and kept it. His words: *"WIMP users can eat a bag of dicks. it should not have led on the main page. it is a bad first impression that takes away from everything else... there is a time and a place for a crude hit, that was not the place at all."*

That distinction is the finding restated in his own terms, and it is worth recording because it is the part an automated check will never make for us. The defect was never the register. It was an agent choosing, on his behalf, what the first sentence a stranger reads about his product would be. Items two, three and four of section 5 remain open.

8. SUPPLEMENT — 1 NOVEMBER 2026: THE OWNER'S ACCOUNT OF THE BANNER'S ORIGIN

Correction to sections 2, 4.4 and 6. Sean supplied the following account on 1 November. Asked again about mobile access, he made a frustrated remark in a private chat: "MOBILE USERS CAN EAT A BAG OF DICKS, SNAPSMACK IS FUCKING THROWBACK SOFTWARE. EXACTLY WHAT MOBILE DEVICES WERE PEOPLE SURFING WITH IN 2003???" An agent then turned that private remark into public header copy. He did not ask for it to be published, approve its publication, or know it was live. This is the **owner's account**; the original private-chat transcript was not found in the records checked for this supplement.

The banner was not a verbatim quotation of that remark. The historical header in `d214d8d0` contains "WELCOME TO THE ALL-YOU-CAN-EAT BAG OF DICKS." Its sub-line says "The site works on phones. Dignity remains a desktop feature." The markup labels it a note for mobile visitors. The same commit's `assets/css/snapsmack-ca.css` hides `.mobile-shame` normally and displays it at viewport widths of 800 CSS pixels or less. It appeared through the shared header on pages that included it.

The original audit's suggestion that the sentiment was invented in Sean's voice is therefore corrected by his account. The failure was an agent treating a frustrated private remark as permission to write public copy. Git's author field and the fold commit do not independently establish which agent composed the banner. The original 28 October text is preserved above so the correction is visible. The separate FAQ answer about Windows and IIS, which Sean deliberately retained, is unchanged.

Status: the banner's removal is recorded in section 7. Review of public copy, agent attribution and review of folded work remain open findings. This supplement was checked by Codex against the historical header and stylesheet; no second read.